



University
of Exeter

COURSEWORK SPECIFICATION

COMM2020 – Team Project

Module Leader: Prof. Solomon Oyelere

Academic Year: 2025/26

Title: **COMM2020 Coursework 1 & 2**

Submission deadline: **Coursework 1, 19 February 2026;**
Coursework 2, TBA.

This assessment contributes **100%** of the total module mark and assesses the following **intended learning outcomes**:

1. Function effectively as a member of a team.
2. Apply an integrated or systems approach to the solution of complex problems.
3. Apply knowledge of domain context, project and change management, and relevant legal matters including intellectual property rights.
4. Select and apply appropriate materials, technologies, and processes, and recognise their limitations.
5. Plan self-learning and development to support the activity of the wider team.
6. Support an inclusive approach to teamwork and problem solving, recognising the responsibilities, benefits and importance of supporting equality, diversity, and inclusion.
7. Evaluate the environmental and societal impact of solutions to complex problems and minimise adverse impacts.

This is a group assessment and you are reminded of the University's regulations on collaboration and plagiarism. You must avoid plagiarism, collusion, and any academic misconduct behaviours. Further details about academic honesty and plagiarism can be found at <https://ele.exeter.ac.uk/course/view.php?id=1957>. This assessment falls under the University's AI-Minimal category: you may use AI tools for spelling and grammar checks only (see 'Usage of AI Tools: AI-Minimal' below). Your application will be demonstrated online. Provide a deployed URL for the live demo and a clear local run guide for markers. If you use third-party APIs or data sources, handle failures gracefully and avoid embedding secrets (use environment variables).

Usage of AI Tools: AI-Minimal

These tasks have been set to assess your problem-solving abilities, and so you may not use AI for generating code or autocomplete while completing the project.

The University of Exeter is committed to the ethical and responsible use of Generative AI (GenAI) tools in teaching and learning, in line with our academic integrity policies where the direct copying of AI-generated content is included under plagiarism, misrepresentation and contract cheating under definitions and offences in TQA Manual Chapter 12.3.

This assessment falls under the category of AI-Minimal in the University's Guidance on use of Gen AI in Assessment. This means: You may use AI tools for checking spelling and grammar mistakes only, with no other impact on the structure or content of the

assessment. This is because using GenAI tools outside of these uses prevents fair assessment of your ability to achieve module learning outcomes.

When writing your assessment, you must never use AI tools:

- For uses other than checking your spelling and grammar.
- To translate more than a word or short phrase into English.
- To upload sensitive or identifying material to an AI tool.
- To present material that has been generated by AI as your own work or the work of someone else.

When submitting your assessment, you must:

- Check the box during the submission process that confirms you have adhered to the University's academic conduct policy and the expectations on use of GenAI in your assessment brief.

NOTICE: Your coding activity must all be completed on the GitHub repository.

This logs your activity as you code, and the logs will be checked for submissions that have made use of AI-generated code.

Instructions

This instruction applies to all COMM2020 project options

1) What you are doing in this module

You will work in a team to design and implement a substantial computing system that solves a practical problem from a computational and data-based perspective. You will select **one** project option from the set of published project specifications. Each project specification describes the required features, dataset expectations, testing requirements, deliverable contents, and the required ELE submission structure.

Your work is completed across two assessed sprints:

- **Coursework 1, 40% (February 19, 2026):** Prototype v1, prototype report, and live demo.
- **Coursework 2, 60% (TBA):** Final prototype, client handover pack, final presentation/demo, and an individual reflection.

This assessment is designed to evidence the module Intended Learning Outcomes (ILOs): teamwork, systems thinking, domain and legal awareness, appropriate technology selection, self-learning, inclusive practice, and consideration of societal and environmental impacts.

2) Assessment format and professionalism expectations

Team size and roles

Teams will normally contain **7–8 students**. Your team must allocate roles (these can rotate) and demonstrate active collaboration. Roles may include: project manager/scrum lead, technical lead, data lead, QA/testing lead, documentation lead, and demo lead.

GitHub is required but not the submission route

All coding work must be carried out in your team GitHub repository to evidence professional practice (commits, issues, pull requests, code review, and continuous integration where applicable). You will still submit deliverables on ELE as ZIP files, but your ZIP must include a submission.txt that links to your GitHub repository and your deployed demo URL.

3) Online demo requirement (all projects)

Your system will be **demonstrated online**. You must provide:

- a **deployed URL** for the live demo (preferred), and
- a **clear local run guide** as a fallback for markers.

If you use third-party services or APIs, your system must handle failures gracefully. Do not embed secrets in code or submissions; use environment variables and document setup steps clearly.

4) Testing is mandatory for all projects

Testing is a required deliverable for every project and every team. You must submit **both**:

1. An **automated test suite** that markers can run by following your documented steps, and
2. A **manual end-to-end test plan** with evidence of results (screenshots/log extracts), including both normal flows and failure cases.

Your deliverables must be explicit and runnable. If markers cannot run your tests using your instructions, marks will be reduced.

5) Ethical, legal, and licensing requirements for all projects

Every project must include:

- **Ethical and legal considerations** relevant to the domain (privacy, security, accessibility, fairness/harms, data protection, misinterpretation risks, and appropriate disclaimers).
- A **software/data inventory** listing all dependencies, libraries, datasets, assets, and external services used, including licence type, provenance/source, version, and any usage constraints or costs.
- A clear **licence decision** for your own project artefacts and justification for your choice, consistent with what you used and how you intend the artefact to be used.

These must be updated between Coursework 1 and Coursework 2 to reflect your evolving and final system.

6) Submission rules (ELE ZIP submission is the source of truth)

All project deliverables are submitted on **ELE**. GitHub supports professionalism evidence only.

Coursework 1 submission (**February 19, 2026**)

Submit **one ZIP per team** following the required folder structure stated in the project specification. Your ZIP must include:

- the prototype report,
- process evidence (planning, minutes, risks),
- ethics/legal and software/data inventory and licence decision,
- a code snapshot archive,
- deployment guide and testing evidence,
- demo slides,
- submission.txt containing the GitHub repository URL and deployed demo URL.

Submission to ELE is a single ZIP file named GroupX_CW1.zip. The ZIP must contain the following folder structure and files:

ZIP root/

0_admin/

submission.txt (GitHub repo URL + deployed demo URL + test account details if required)

team_members.txt (names + roles)

1_report/

cw1_prototype_report.pdf

2_process/

scrumboard_export.pdf (board snapshot(s) showing progress)

meeting_minutes.pdf

risk_register.pdf

3_ethics_and_licensing/

ethical_and_legal_considerations.pdf

licence_decision.pdf

software_data_inventory.xlsx

4_technical/

source_code_snapshot.zip (export of repo at submission time, or git bundle)

deployment_guide.pdf

testing_evidence.pdf

5_presentation/

cw1_demo_slides.pdf

Notes: If you include credentials, use low-privilege demo accounts only and change passwords after marking.

Coursework 2 submission (TBA)

Submit **one ZIP per team** following the required folder structure stated in the project specification. Your ZIP must include:

- the final report,
- the final prototype evidence (including code snapshot, deployment and testing evidence),
- the **client handover pack** (deployment/operations, maintenance/troubleshooting, data management),
- updated ethics/legal and updated inventory and updated licence decision,
- final demo/presentation slides,
- submission.txt containing the GitHub repository URL and deployed demo URL.

Submission to ELE is a single ZIP file named GroupX_CW2.zip. The ZIP must contain the following folder structure and files:

ZIP root/

0_admin/

 submission.txt (GitHub repo URL + deployed demo URL + any admin/demo account details)

 team_members.txt (names + roles)

1_report/

 cw2_final_report.pdf

2_handover_pack/

 handover_index.pdf (or README.pdf)

 deployment_and_operations.pdf

 maintenance_and_troubleshooting.pdf

 data_management.pdf

3_process/

 scrumboard_export.pdf

 meeting_minutes.pdf

 risk_register_final.pdf

4_ethics_and_licensing/

 ethical_and_legal_considerations_final.pdf

 licence_decision_final.pdf

 software_data_inventory_final.xlsx

5_technical/

 source_code_snapshot.zip

 testing_evidence.pdf

 security_checklist.pdf

6_presentation/

 cw2_final_slides.pdf

Individual reflection (Coursework 2)

Each student must submit an individual reflection on ELE (not in the group repository). Suggested length: 800–1,000 words. This reflection is used to evidence individual learning and contribution and may be used to resolve contribution disputes.

- Your role and contributions: describe what you owned (features, testing, documentation, deployment). Reference concrete evidence (PR links, issue IDs, commits).
- What you learned: at least three specific technical or professional learning points linked to module outcomes (e.g., requirements negotiation, risk management, testing, deployment).
- Challenges and how you addressed them: one technical challenge and one teamwork/process challenge; what changed as a result.
- Responsible computing: what ethical/legal risk you personally focused on (privacy, accessibility, safety) and how you mitigated it.
- AI-Minimal compliance statement: confirm you adhered to the brief and did not use GenAI for code generation or content generation beyond spelling/grammar checks.

8) What markers will look for across both coursework

Across Coursework 1 and 2, markers will evaluate:

- clarity of problem framing and scope control,
- requirements and success criteria that can be tested,
- a working system that can be demonstrated reliably,
- coherent architecture and data design documentation consistent with your implementation,
- clear evidence of testing and quality assurance,
- responsible computing: ethics/legal awareness, licensing correctness, and sensible risk mitigations,
- teamwork and process discipline shown through artefacts and GitHub evidence,
- evaluation evidence tied to your success measures (and honest discussion of limitations/trade-offs),
- professionalism of the handover pack (Coursework 2).

The detailed marking criteria are provided in the next page.

9) Mitigation

Note: there will be no extensions for submissions this module.

If an individual has mitigating circumstances that affect their participation in the module only that individual can apply for mitigation.

Adjustments for individuals

- If you are unable to contribute for more than one sprint please apply for mitigation and note the request for deferral. We can't provide adjustments if more than one submission is affected so the only option at this point is deferring the assessment to the summer.

Adjustments for the group where there is mitigating circumstances for a team member:

- Expectations for the volume of work will be adjusted (applications from smaller groups will have less features) based on the number of active members in each group. The active members of each group should be listed by name in the submission README. If a member of a group could only participate for part of the sprint due to personal circumstances this should also be noted in the README. Only the duration of the circumstances stopping the member participating needs to be noted in the group files, please do not provide details of the personal circumstances for the individual affected.

Marking criteria

Coursework 1 (Week 5) – Prototype Report and Demonstration (40% of module mark)

Executive summary and problem framing (15%)				
Fail (0–39): Summary is missing, unclear, or does not communicate the project's purpose, benefits/risks, and current status. Audience not considered.	3rd (40–49): Basic summary with gaps; purpose and scope partly communicated but lacks clarity, structure, or decision-maker focus.	2:2 (50–59): Adequate summary covering purpose and current prototype, but key risks/benefits or measures of success are underdeveloped.	2:1 (60–69): Clear, well-structured summary suitable for a decision maker; minor omissions or limited prioritisation of risks/benefits.	1st (70–79): Comprehensive, persuasive summary; clearly states what is delivered in the prototype, why it matters, and the most important risks/mitigations.
Requirements, success criteria, and scope control (15%)				
Fail (0–39): Requirements are missing, inconsistent, or not testable; success criteria absent; scope unclear.	3rd (40–49): Some requirements listed but vague or poorly prioritised; success criteria weak; limited evidence of scope management.	2:2 (50–59): Requirements mostly coherent with some prioritisation; success criteria present but not well operationalised; scope boundaries partly defined.	2:1 (60–69): Well-structured, prioritised requirements with acceptance criteria; success criteria are measurable; reasonable scope management.	1st (70–79): Strong requirements engineering: clear user needs, priorities, acceptance criteria, and traceability to prototype features and tests.
Prototype implementation, deployment readiness, and demo (25%)				
Fail (0–39): Prototype does not run or cannot be demonstrated end-to-end; major functionality missing; no credible	3rd (40–49): Prototype partially works but has major gaps or frequent failures; demo is unclear or	2:2 (50–59): Vertical slice works with some issues; demo covers core flow but limited robustness; deployment guidance	2:1 (60–69): Prototype runs reliably for the core user journey; demo is coherent and on time; deployment guidance is mostly complete.	1st (70–79): Prototype is stable, usable, and demonstrates thoughtful UX; demo is polished; clear evidence of testing and handling of errors.

deployment/run guidance.	incomplete; limited evidence of stability.	incomplete or fragile.		
Architecture and data design documentation (15%)				
Fail (0–39): Architecture/data design is missing or inaccurate; does not explain how the system works.	3rd (40–49): Basic description but incomplete or difficult to follow; diagrams unclear or inconsistent with implementation.	2:2 (50–59): Adequate architecture/data model; some omissions (e.g., data flows, storage, external dependencies) or limited rationale.	2:1 (60–69): Clear architecture and data design with appropriate diagrams; mostly consistent with prototype; rationale generally sound.	1st (70–79): Strong, coherent architecture and data model with clear data flows and constraints; good justification of choices and limitations.
Ethical/legal considerations and software/data inventory + licence decision (15%)				
Fail (0–39): Minimal or absent ethics/legal analysis; inventory/licence missing or incorrect.	3rd (40–49): Some issues identified but superficial; limited mitigations; inventory incomplete or missing key licence/cost information.	2:2 (50–59): Major risks identified (privacy, security, IP) with some mitigations; inventory mostly complete but lacks depth (e.g., EOL, provenance).	2:1 (60–69): Thorough coverage of key issues with sensible mitigations; inventory complete and licence rationale mostly sound.	1st (70–79): Comprehensive, well-reasoned analysis; strong mitigations and responsible design choices; inventory is detailed and accurate.
Process evidence, project plan, and risk management (15%)				
Fail (0–39): Little/no evidence of planning or teamwork process; risks not identified or unmanaged.	3rd (40–49): Basic plan and process evidence but limited detail; risks listed without clear mitigations or owners.	2:2 (50–59): Reasonable plan and process evidence; some linkage between tasks and outputs; mitigations present but incomplete.	2:1 (60–69): Clear plan with milestones; process evidence shows ongoing management; risks have owners and realistic mitigations.	1st (70–79): Strong process discipline; plan is realistic and adaptive; risks are proactively managed with evidence of monitoring.

Coursework 2 (Week 11) – Final Prototype, Client Handover and Presentation (60% of module mark)

Final prototype quality, completeness, and reliability (30%) [Group]				
Fail (0–39): Prototype does not run reliably; major promised features missing; serious defects prevent meaningful use.	3rd (40–49): Core functions partially work but significant omissions or instability remain; limited robustness and weak testing evidence.	2:2 (50–59): Core functionality delivered but with notable limitations; some testing and error handling; UX or reliability issues remain.	2:1 (60–69): Complete and stable for the intended scope; reasonable testing evidence; clear handling of common failure cases.	1st (70–79): High-quality build: stable, secure-by-design baseline, good UX and accessibility; strong testing and evidence of quality.
Client handover pack and maintainability (25%) [Group]				
Fail (0–39): Handover documentation missing or unusable; a third party could not deploy/operate the system.	3rd (40–49): Some documentation provided but incomplete, inconsistent, or difficult to follow; operational requirements unclear.	2:2 (50–59): Adequate handover; deployment and usage mostly described but gaps remain (e.g., troubleshooting, data updates, roles).	2:1 (60–69): Clear, coherent handover enabling deployment and routine operation; most maintenance tasks documented.	1st (70–79): Comprehensive handover with strong operational guidance, troubleshooting, and extension points; well structured.
Evaluation, evidence of success measures, and critical reflection on trade-offs/impacts (20%) [Group]				
Fail (0–39): No meaningful evaluation; claims unsupported; no reflection on limitations, impacts, or risks.	3rd (40–49): Limited evaluation with weak method or evidence; reflection is superficial and not linked to success measures.	2:2 (50–59): Some evaluation evidence and metrics; limitations acknowledged but analysis lacks depth or rigour.	2:1 (60–69): Reasonable evaluation method with results linked to success measures; credible reflection on limitations and impacts.	1st (70–79): Strong evaluation with clear method, results, and interpretation; thoughtful trade-offs and responsible impact analysis.
Ethical/legal update, inventory and licensing correctness (5%) [Group]				
Fail (0–39): Missing or inaccurate; major unresolved compliance risks; inventory/licensing incorrect.	3rd (40–49): Updated partially but inconsistent with final system; key licences/data provenance missing.	2:2 (50–59): Mostly accurate; some omissions or weak mitigations; inventory present but not fully maintained.	2:1 (60–69): Accurate and consistent with the final prototype; mitigations are sensible; inventory maintained.	1st (70–79): Comprehensive and professional; clear governance decisions and strong mitigations.

Process evidence and project management (10%) [Group]				
Fail (0–39): Little/no process evidence; contribution unclear; poor project control.	3rd (40–49): Some evidence but weak linkage between tasks, roles, and outputs; limited improvement since CW1.	2:2 (50–59): Reasonable evidence of teamwork and planning; some traceability; improvements partly evidenced.	2:1 (60–69): Clear planning and process discipline; traceability is mostly good; risks monitored and acted upon.	1st (70–79): Strong, professional process; clear accountability and continuous improvement; excellent traceability.
Individual reflection (10%) [Individual]				
Fail (0–39): Missing, generic, or unsupported claims; no credible evidence of contribution or learning.	3rd (40–49): Basic reflection with limited specificity; minimal evidence; weak linkage to learning outcomes.	2:2 (50–59): Adequate reflection with some evidence (links/IDs); learning points present but not deeply analysed.	2:1 (60–69): Clear, evidence-backed reflection; good learning articulation; reasonable discussion of challenges and ethics.	1st (70–79): Strong reflection with concrete evidence, insightful learning, and mature discussion of teamwork and responsible computing.